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PRESIDENT GIFTS MOHAMMED MILESTONE ALBUM

President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan met His Highness Sheikh Mohammed Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Vice-President and Prime Minister of the UAE and Ruler of Dubai, at Qasr Al Bahr in Abu Dhabi. During the meeting, the President gifted Sheikh Mohammed a signed commemorative photo album highlighting key moments from their shared journey in service of the UAE and its record of achievement. The gesture marked 20 years of Sheikh Mohammed leading the federal government.

UAE hails US move against Muslim Brotherhood

Ministry highlights UAE's commitment to fighting terrorism, promoting security

ABU DHABI

The UAE has welcomed the announcement by the administration of US President Donald Trump designating several branches of the Muslim Brotherhood in Lebanon, Jordan, and Egypt as terrorist organisations.

In a statement, the Ministry of Foreign Affairs (MoFA) affirmed that the US measure reflects the sustained and systematic efforts undertaken by the administration of President Trump to counter violence and destabilising activities carried out by terrorist Muslim Brotherhood branches wherever they operate.

Key measure

Furthermore, the Ministry emphasised that this step represents a key measure within the United States' efforts to deprive these terrorist branches of the resources that enable them to engage in, support, or justify acts of extremism, hatred, and terrorism. The Ministry underscored the UAE's support for all international efforts aimed at combating extremism and terrorism, and promoting regional and international security and stability.

Earlier in the day, the Lebanese branch of the Muslim Brotherhood was listed as a Foreign Terrorist Organisation (FTO) by the US State Department, while the Egyptian and Jordanian chapters were classified as Specially Designated Global Terrorists (SDGTs) by the US Treasury Department. These measures will subject the groups to sanctions, including asset freezes, transaction prohibitions and other restrictions designed to cut off resources that could be used to engage in or support violence. — WAM

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US pulls some personnel amid Iran tensions

QATAR SAYS MEASURES IN PLACE TO PROTECT RESIDENTS, INFRASTRUCTURE

DUBAI

BY STEPHEN N. R.
Senior Associate Editor

Trump has warned of 'very strong action' if Iran executes protesters and urged Iranians to continue demonstrating.

The US has begun withdrawing some personnel from key military bases in the Middle East as a precaution amid sharply escalating tensions with Iran, after Tehran warned it could strike American installations across the region if Washington intervenes militarily, a US official told Reuters yesterday.

The move highlights growing concern over a potential regional spillover as Iran grapples with one of the deadliest crackdowns on protests in its modern history, even as US President Donald Trump issues increasingly explicit threats of action in support of demonstrators.

A senior Iranian official told Reuters that Tehran has warned neighbouring countries hosting US forces that their bases would be targeted if attacks on Iran were launched from their territory. Iran, the official said, has urged regional governments to restrain Washington and prevent any strike.

10,000 US troops

Three diplomats said some US personnel had been advised to leave Al Udeid Air Base in Qatar — the largest American base in the Middle East and the forward headquarters of US Central Command — by yesterday evening. It hosts around 10,000 US troops.

Qatar said the removal of some personnel from Al Udeid was due to "current regional tensions", stressing that it continues to take all necessary measures to safeguard citizens, residents, critical infrastructure and military facilities.

The movement mirrors steps taken more than a week before US strikes on Iran last year, after which Tehran retaliated with a missile attack on Al Udeid.

The US maintains a broad military presence across the region, including its Fifth Fleet headquarters in Bahrain.

India has, meanwhile, advised its nationals in Iran to leave using available routes, citing safety concerns amid escalating unrest.

Trump has warned of "very strong action" if Iran executes protesters and urged Iranians to continue demonstrating. Rights group HRANA says more than 2,400 protesters have been killed so far.

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